

## SCOTCH N' SODA BOARD OF DIRECTORS

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## THANK YOU TO OUR

### WONDERFUL DONORS!

#### BOTTLE OF SCOTCH

Dan Freeman  
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#### SCOTCH AND WATER

Eric Dietz  
 Nathan Blinn  
 Maria Sabater  
 John Cohn  
 John Cohn  
 Paras Shah

#### UPCOMING EVENTS

4/8 @ 1-2 PM THE NO PARKING PLAYERS' CARNIVAL SHOW  
 4/17 NEW WORKS COFFEEHOUSE PRESENTS SCENEFEST: REVERSALS  
 4/22-4/23 @ 9 PM CAMP TISBERT

#### SHOT OF SCOTCH

Bradley Plaxen  
 Sarah Burke  
 Ruiiran Xun  
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 Lisa Peppas  
 Corinne Rockoff  
 Christine Barnes  
 Michelle Christensen  
 Peter Wernett  
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 Tyler Welsh  
 Jordan Speranzo  
 Katie Mae Ryan  
 Jonah Dublin

# RENT

## CUC RANGOS BALLROOM

THURSDAY 4/7 @ 7PM

FRIDAY 4/8 @ 7 PM AND 11 PM

SATURDAY 4/9 @ 2 PM AND 7 PM

Book, Music, and Lyrics by

Jonathan Larson

Musical Arrangements: Steve Skinner Original Concept/Additional Lyrics: Billy Aronson

Musical Supervision and Additional Arrangements: Kim Moll Dramaturg: Lynn Thomson

RENT was originally produced in New York by New York Theatre Workshop and on Broadway by Jeffrey Sklar, Kevin McCollum, Allan S. Jordan and Greg Theater Workshop

DIRECTED BY CAROLINE HOLMES AND KATIA PEPPAS

ASST. BY LEVI CHAPLIN-IOEBELL

DRAMATURGY BY AYSHA ZACKARIA

ASST. BY MARTIN BAKER AND ELLY LIEU WOLHARDT

MUSIC DIRECTED BY RUIRAN XUN AND CHRISTIAN ENGELHARDT

CHOREOGRAPHED BY ALEX SHEFFIELD

ASST. BY MARIANA GARZON

RENT is presented through special arrangement with Music Theatre International (MTI). All authorized performance materials are also supplied by MTI.

Funded in part by your Student Activities Fee





## RENT: ITS PAST, OUR PRESENT

"Give in to Love or Live in Fear" As our production has come to fruition, this idea has remained central to our telling this story. Right now, we are adjusting to a new reality and facing fear, isolation, and loss. At the same time, many of us are interrogating how to dismantle the systems of white supremacy, capitalism, and hetero-cis-normativity that target marginalized communities and maintain oppressive power structures. In portraying 1989 New York City wrestling with these same systems, particularly the queer community of Alphabet City facing social and medical insecurity, we strive to enact collective catharsis for a modern audience. Although AIDS and COVID-19 are similar in their pervasive presences, the AIDS crisis resulted in higher degree stigma with its unique association to the queer community. By drawing this connection, we hope to uplift those stories with a newfound compassion and understanding. Even if RENT's characters struggle to find hope, they ultimately choose to find love and joy in a time of pain. The characters may not be perfect, but they invariably and courageously fight for their unique visions of the future. This seemingly simple interpretation isn't wholly common in this musical's past productions, especially considering the turmoil surrounding its inception.

Jonathan Larson is the creator of RENT, but the validity of his authorship has been contested since its inception. While the piece is usually attributed wholly to Larson, there are several people, credited and uncredited, who aided in its creation. Billy Aronson initially conceptualized the idea of adapting Puccini's 1896 opera La Bohème in 1980s New York, and gave Larson permission to continue with the adaptation. He is credited with additional lyrics, but does not assume the title of Co-Creator. Dramaturg Lynn Thomson collaborated extensively with Larson, supervising essential revisions to the lyrics and book. After his death, Thomson brought suit against the Larson Heirs, seeking credit as Co-Author as well as additional royalties, but the court ruled against her. Author Sarah Schulman believes that Larson borrowed characters and plot points from her loosely autobiographical novel People in Trouble. Larson, as a heterosexual, cisgender, white man, drew heavily on the lived experiences of people of color and members of the LGBTQIA+ community, including Schulman. Even if he is considered sole author of RENT, there is no question that we owe much of the production's success to those whom this story truly belongs. Our production acknowledges this discrepancy by interrogating the script's bias and encouraging each participant to find their voice in a communal ownership of the show. By acknowledging and enacting these intentions, we hope to uplift each member's contribution and each audience member's critical engagement. Thank you for bearing witness with us.

Aysha Zackaria  
Dramaturg

Caroline Holmes  
Co-Director

Katia Peppas  
Co-Director

## CONTENT WARNING

This production of RENT includes depictions of death, violence, sexual content, HIV/AIDS, homophobia, addiction, homelessness, and police presence; mentions of drug use, eating disorders, and suicide; and use of explicit and homophobic language.

ANY VIDEO AND/OR AUDIO RECORDING OF THIS PRODUCTION IS STRICTLY PROHIBITED

## CREATIVE STAFF

Co-Director: Caroline Holmes  
Co-Director: Katia Peppas  
Assistant Director: Levi Ohapiin-Loebell  
Dramaturg: Aysha Zackaria  
Assistant Dramaturg: Martin Baker  
Assistant Dramaturg: Ely Liu Wolhardt  
Co-Music Director: Rutun Xun  
Co-Music Director: Christian Engelhardt  
Choreographer: Alex Sheffield  
Assistant Choreographer: Marlane Garzon

## PRODUCTION STAFF

Co-Production Manager: Nina Kanamajuru  
Co-Production Manager: Sophie Vincens (she/they/ne)  
Co-Stage Manager: Victoria Kuo  
Co-Stage Manager: Nina Tripathi  
Co-Stage Manager: Kelly Xu  
Technical Director: Maddie Burroughs  
Assistant Technical Director: Queenie Chen  
Assistant Technical Director: Varsha Ramanujam

## DESIGNERS

Scenic Designer: James Garcia  
Assistant Scenic Designer: Jacoy Lozada  
Assistant Scenic Designer: Justin Peng  
Lighting Designer: Ariel Uy (they/them)  
Assistant Lighting Designer: Queenie Chen  
Sound Designer: Jacyln Peng  
Sound Designer: Liberty Fyfeb  
Sound Monitor: Korena Yu  
Costume Designer: Elise Ghapman  
Costume Designer: Miranda Boodheshwar  
Assistant Costume Designer: Madeline Hoogstraten  
Hair & Makeup Designer: Olave Katyal  
Publicity Head: Cynthia Xu  
Assistant Publicity Head: Soomin Kong

## IMPLEMENTERS

Master Carpenter: Flannery McKeat  
Assistant Master Carpenter: Alex Echols  
Paint-Glazes-Lacola-Gastelblanco  
Lead Electrician: Ely Liu Wolhardt  
Assistant Lead Electrician: Petran De  
Sound Engineer: Sam Chen  
Sound Engineer: Jacky Gao  
Props Head: Julietta Montalegre  
Costumes Head: Abby Miller-Peterson (they/them)  
Assistant Costumes Head: Juliet Foote  
Hair & Makeup Head: Ellie Burckhardt  
House Manager: Lucia Shen

## CAST

Roger: Nick Grosso  
Mort: Luke Studdeth  
Collins: Quincy Eaton  
Benny: Clayton Edwards  
Joanne: Vicky Walters  
Angel: Riley Santlago  
Mami: Lisset Martinez  
Maureen: Shaelyn Parker  
Ensemble: Senam Anaglate,  
Marianne Baldwin, Matthew Blankley,  
Charlie Botts, Chloe Brown (they/them),  
Gindy Chen (she/her), Ash Gelber,  
Sean Hodges (he/him), Zach Lee,  
Lance Miller, Ayda Ozdoganlar,  
Natalie Salazar, V Shinau (they/them),  
Stephen Teo, Emme Wetzel (she/her)

## CREW

(\*Run Crew)

CHARITY:  
Charlie Botts  
Chloe Brown (they/them)  
Elizabeth Chang-Davidson  
Hazel Froling  
James Garcia  
Joe Kurtz  
Lisset Martinez  
Shahzadi Padda  
Justin Peng  
Peter Ragona  
Kate Russo  
Emily Schneider  
Brian Truong  
Sophie Vincens (she/they/ne)  
Anna Watson

## LIGHTING

Lyris Ohang  
Shannon Ding  
Logan Donahue  
Alex Gotsis  
Charles Liu  
Felicia Liu  
Tabetha Pina  
Alex Strasser  
Stella Yim

## SOUND

Maddie Thai-Tsang  
Lohen Xu\*

## COSTUMES

Juliet Foote\*  
Julia Levine\*  
Olivia Osheveck\*  
Abby Miller-Peterson\* (they/them)  
Kate Russo\*

## HAIR & MAKEUP

Ellie Burckhardt\*  
Alexandra Bettschenko\*  
Ash Gelber\*  
Amalia Komon  
Yirano Li\*  
Emme Wetzel\* (she/her)

## PAINT

Matthew Blankley  
Lucia Gastelblanco  
Juliet Foote  
Ash Gelber  
Lily Hsuan  
Socaili Kong  
Lance Miller  
Ayda Ozdoganlar  
Riley Santiago  
V Shinau (they/them)  
Lucia Shen

## PROPS

Julietta Montalegre\*  
Emily Gekty

## BOARD OPS

Petran De\*  
Peter Ragona\*  
SPOT OP  
Brian Truong\*

## SPECIAL THANKS

Jack Orone  
Perry Naseck